

/etc/hosts: The IP address and hostnames of other machines on the network. You can edit it appropriately to be able to use other machines by name rather than by IP addresses. You can also use the file to map the IP address of those websites for which you do not want to wait even a millisecond. Google is one such candidate.

/etc/passwd: This file contains the information about the users existing on the system. If you want to understand the file, look for the Linux password reset trick in the April 2011 issue.

/etc/shadow: This file contains the password hashes of users on the system.

/etc/resolv.conf: In case you want to manually set up the DNS servers, you can simply edit this file. If you followed the steps for network configuration earlier, the file on your system should contain something like:

- # Generated by NetworkManager
- nameserver 8.8.8.8
- nameserver 208.67.222.222
- nameserver 8.8.4.4

We believe you are able to see the simple pattern in file.

There are a lot of other important files in the `/etc/` folder which would govern much more delicate parts of the functionalities of the OS. It is recommended that you do not try to edit them by hands unless of course, you know perfectly well what they mean and what might get changed by changing them. It is also recommended that before editing, you back up the files. We mention them here anticipating they will not be misused or handled carelessly.

/etc/apt/sources.list: The list of software repositories from where Ubuntu would get its software list and filenames to download later.

/etc/bluetooth/*.conf: The files here determine how the computer behaves with other bluetooth enabled devices. Do not edit them by hand unless utterly needed. A misconfigured set of files might create a lot of troubles.

/etc/init/*.conf: These files contain the configuration of many services which do not run in user mode. They help determine the options which these services use when starting.

/etc/modprobe.d/: Files in this directory determine which all kernel modules will be loaded and which are blacklisted. Kernel modules enable functionalities for the kernel without which a particular hardware or sometimes even a service will not work properly.

/etc/rc*.d/: Files in these directories are responsible for how the system